

DAILY MARKET BRIEFING

Wednesday, 13 May 2026

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LIVE MARKET SNAPSHOT — 13 May 2026

MARKET	PRICE	CHANGE	SIGNAL
S&P; 500	7,351	-0.83%	Caution
Nasdaq 100	25,879	-1.50%	Caution
Dow Jones	49,493	-0.42%	Watch
VIX (Fear)	19.04	+3.59%	Elevated
Gold (oz)	\$4,690	-0.3%	Support
Crude Oil (WTI)	\$107	+1.8%	Bullish
Bitcoin	\$80,861	-0.4%	Neutral

WHAT HAPPENED TODAY

THE GOOD NEWS

Q1 corporate earnings across the S&P 500 are coming in exceptionally strong — up 27% compared to the same period last year, the best earnings growth since late 2021. Think of it like most big companies just published their school report cards, and most of them got A grades. That is good news for investors who own shares in those companies. The US economy keeps growing, jobs are plentiful, and consumer spending remains resilient.

THE CAUTION FLAG

US inflation came in hotter than expected in April — sitting at 3.8%, the highest in three years. Imagine your grocery bill going up again just when you thought it was levelling off. Higher inflation means the US Federal Reserve is less likely to cut interest rates soon, which is what caused Wall Street to pull back today. Technology stocks — which had been the market leaders — fell the hardest (Nasdaq -1.5%), because they are most sensitive to interest rate changes.

TONIGHT'S BIG EVENT

Tomorrow (14 May), President Trump flies to Beijing for a historic face-to-face summit with China's President Xi Jinping — the first such meeting in nearly a decade. Markets are on edge: the two leaders are expected to discuss the ongoing US-Iran conflict (which is keeping oil at \$107), trade tariffs, and semiconductors (AI chips). Any positive signals from Beijing could spark a sharp rally. Any breakdown or disappointment could push markets lower. Watch for news overnight.

TIER 1 — STARTER CLIENT (\$1,000 – \$3,000 per trade)

Welcome, new investor. Everything below is written in plain language. We always tell you the risk before you put in a single dollar.

IDEA 1: GOLD (XAU/USD)

RISK: Medium

Plain-English Explanation:	Gold is like the world's oldest safety blanket. When people get scared about wars, inflation, or political drama, they rush into gold — pushing its price up. Right now, with oil expensive and a US-Iran war simmering, gold has strong reasons to hold its value.	
Entry Level:	\$4,680 – \$4,700	
Target Price:	\$4,850	
Stop Loss:	\$4,600	
Broker Note:	<i>Best for beginners. Easy to understand. Hold 2–4 weeks.</i>	
Capital	Suggested Lot Size	Max Risk
\$1,000	0.02 lots	~\$80 risk
\$2,000	0.03 lots	~\$120 risk
\$3,000	0.05 lots	~\$200 risk

IDEA 2: CRUDE OIL (WTI)		RISK: High
Plain-English Explanation:	Oil is the fuel the world runs on. With the Strait of Hormuz — a narrow sea channel where 20% of global oil passes — effectively blocked by the US-Iran conflict, oil supplies are squeezed. Less supply + same demand = higher price. Like petrol stations running low.	
Entry Level:	\$105 – \$107	
Target Price:	\$115	
Stop Loss:	\$101	
Broker Note:	<i>Higher risk. News-driven. Place stop loss BEFORE entering.</i>	
Capital	Suggested Lot Size	Max Risk
\$1,000	0.5 lots	~\$100 risk
\$2,000	1 lot	~\$200 risk
\$3,000	1.5 lots	~\$300 risk

IDEA 3: S&P; 500 INDEX (US500)		RISK: Medium
Plain-English Explanation:	Owning the S&P; 500 is like buying a tiny share of the 500 biggest US companies all at once — Apple, Microsoft, Amazon, all in one. Today it dipped. The Trump-Xi summit tomorrow could be a catalyst to bounce back if positive news comes out.	
Entry Level:	7,330 – 7,360	
Target Price:	7,550	
Stop Loss:	7,200	
Broker Note:	<i>Wait until AFTER Trump-Xi headline to enter. Direction unclear before summit.</i>	
Capital	Suggested Lot Size	Max Risk
\$1,000	0.1 lots	~\$130 risk
\$2,000	0.2 lots	~\$260 risk
\$3,000	0.3 lots	~\$390 risk

THE SEATBELT RULE — YOUR STOP LOSS EXPLAINED

A stop loss is your car's seatbelt. You wear it BEFORE the accident happens, not after. In trading, a stop loss is a pre-set instruction that automatically closes your trade if the market moves against you by a set amount. Example: you buy Gold at \$4,690. You set a stop loss at \$4,600. If Gold falls to \$4,600, your trade closes automatically and you lose only ~\$90 per unit — not everything. Without a stop loss, you could lose far more if the market keeps falling. ALWAYS set your stop loss before you open a trade.

TIER 2 — PREMIUM CLIENT (\$50,000+ Capital)

Premium clients think in portfolios, not single trades. Below is your two-bucket framework for the current environment: protect capital first, grow it second.

SAFETY BUCKET (50–60% of Portfolio) — 3–6 Month Horizon

Asset	Allocation	Target / Stop	Rationale
Gold (XAU/USD)	25–30%	Tgt: \$5,000 Stop: \$4,400	Geopolitical hedge: US-Iran war, USD inflation at 3.8%, central bank buying continues. Gold acts as portfolio insurance.
S&P; 500 Broad Index (US500)	25–30%	Tgt: 8,000 Stop: 6,900	Q1 earnings +27% YoY. Long-term structural bull case intact despite near-term volatility. Dips are buying opportunities for patient capital.

GROWTH BUCKET (30–40% of Portfolio) — Tactical Positions

Asset	Allocation	Scenario / Trigger	Rationale
Crude Oil (WTI/USD)	10–15%	If Hormuz remains blocked: hold long. If ceasefire announced: close immediately.	Supply disruption is structural while Strait stays closed. Oil could test \$115–120.
Nasdaq 100 (US Tech)	10–15%	If Trump-Xi summit positive: BUY dip at 25,700. If negative: wait, do NOT chase.	AI-driven earnings super-cycle. Any trade deal unlock = re-rating for semis and cloud.
Bitcoin (BTC/USD)	5–10%	Hold if above \$78,000. Add on pullback to \$72,000–75,000.	Institutional adoption accelerating. Treat as digital gold, not speculation.

FULL PORTFOLIO ALLOCATION SUMMARY

Asset	Bucket	Suggested %	Why
Gold	Safety	25–30%	Inflation + geopolitical hedge
S&P; 500	Safety	25–30%	Earnings strength, long-term bull
Crude Oil	Growth	10–15%	Hormuz supply crunch
Nasdaq 100	Growth	10–15%	AI cycle, China summit catalyst
Bitcoin	Growth	5–10%	Digital store of value, institutional bid
Cash/Reserve	Reserve	5–10%	Dry powder for post-summit opportunities

TRUMP-XI SUMMIT — BINARY SCENARIO PLAYBOOK

IF POSITIVE (trade deal signals, ceasefire cooperation):

Buy Nasdaq 100 on the open above 26,000. Target 27,000–27,500. Reduce oil position as Hormuz narrative softens. S&P; 500 likely to rally toward 7,600–7,700. Bitcoin could see a momentum push above \$85,000.

IF NEGATIVE (no deal, escalation signals, Taiwan tensions):

Do NOT chase equities lower. Let the dust settle for 24–48 hours. Gold becomes the primary positioning — add to \$4,700–4,750 range. Oil likely spikes above \$112 — existing oil longs remain profitable. S&P; 500 could test 7,100–7,200 support. Wait for that level before adding.

THE PREMIUM CLIENT MINDSET

Markets reward patience and punish panic. The greatest investors in history made their money not by predicting every move, but by positioning early and holding through volatility with conviction. Today's pullback is not a crisis — it is a recalibration. Your edge as a premium client is time horizon and discipline. The next 48 hours will create opportunities. Be ready, not reactive.

WHAT TO WATCH THIS WEEK — RISK EVENTS

HIGH	Trump-Xi Beijing Summit (Wed–Thu) First US-China face-to-face in nearly a decade. Any trade deal signals, semiconductor export deal, or Iran cooperation statement could move markets sharply in either direction.
HIGH	US-Iran Ceasefire Talks (Ongoing) The ceasefire is on 'massive life support'. Iran rejected the US proposal. Any fresh military incident in the Strait of Hormuz could spike oil above \$115 immediately.
MED	Fed Officials Speaking (Thu–Fri) Following hot April CPI (3.8%), Federal Reserve speakers will set the tone for interest rate expectations. Hawkish comments = more market pressure on equities.
MED	Q1 Earnings — 187 Reports (Wed) Today is the heaviest earnings day of the season. Watch for any guidance cuts, especially from consumer and energy names. A negative surprise could accelerate the pullback.
LOW	China Economic Data (Thu) China releases retail sales and industrial production data. Strong numbers ahead of the summit would be positive for emerging market sentiment and risk assets broadly.

WHY RISK MANAGEMENT MATTERS MOST AT RECORD HIGHS

The S&P; 500 sits near all-time high territory, which means the market has already priced in a lot of good news. When everything is priced for perfection, even a small negative surprise — hotter inflation, a geopolitical flare-up, or disappointing earnings guidance — can cause a sharper-than-expected sell-off. This is precisely when stop losses, position sizing, and the discipline to hold cash are your greatest assets. The traders who survive long term are not the ones who were always right — they are the ones who limited their losses when they were wrong.

EM ANGLE — INDONESIA & MALAYSIA CLIENT NOTE

Market / Currency	Level	Direction	Key Note
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IHSG (Jakarta Composite)	~6,858	Down 0.7%	Tracking Wall Street weakness; energy stocks outperforming on oil rally
USD/IDR (Rupiah)	17,507	Weak IDR	Rupiah under pressure -2.25% past month; oil costs hurt import bill
USD/MYR (Ringgit)	3.9620	Weak MYR	Ringgit softening; Malaysia is oil exporter — partially offsetting benefit

TALKING POINT FOR INDONESIAN & MALAYSIAN CLIENTS

Today's market tells a two-sided story for your clients. The Rupiah (IDR) weakening against the US Dollar means that dollar-denominated assets like Gold and US equities are becoming even more expensive in local currency terms — but it also means that gains in those assets translate to MORE Rupiah when you convert back. For Malaysian clients, as a net oil exporter, the country partially benefits from higher crude prices at \$107, which supports the government budget and Petronas revenues. The IHSG dipped today but remains structurally supported. Key conversation: diversification into USD-denominated assets acts as both a currency hedge and a growth opportunity for Indonesian and Malaysian investors.

WHATSAPP CLIENT SUMMARY — Copy & Send

Good morning. Markets pulled back today as US inflation came in higher than expected at 3.8%, pushing Wall Street lower (S&P; 500 -0.83%, Nasdaq -1.5%). Oil remains elevated at \$107 on the ongoing Strait of Hormuz disruption, and Gold holds near \$4,690. The key event is tomorrow's Trump-Xi summit in Beijing - a positive outcome could spark a sharp rally while disappointment may add further pressure. We recommend holding existing positions with stop losses in place and watching for summit headlines before making new moves. Please contact your account manager for personalised guidance.

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